PRD: Increasing Zomato Text Reviews

Developing a solution to increase text reviews in the Food Delivery vertical.

Team: Ratings & Reviews (Food Delivery)
Contributors: Sarada Sahoo (Product Manager)
Status: In Development
Launch Date: 31st November '24
Resources: Check Source URLs

Problem Definition

While **63%** of Zomato's **3.4 million monthly active users** rate orders, most **omit text reviews**. Users find the **process time-consuming** and **lacks perceived value**. Addressing these **issues is crucial for Zomato's profitability**, as food delivery is the only profitable segment.

Goals

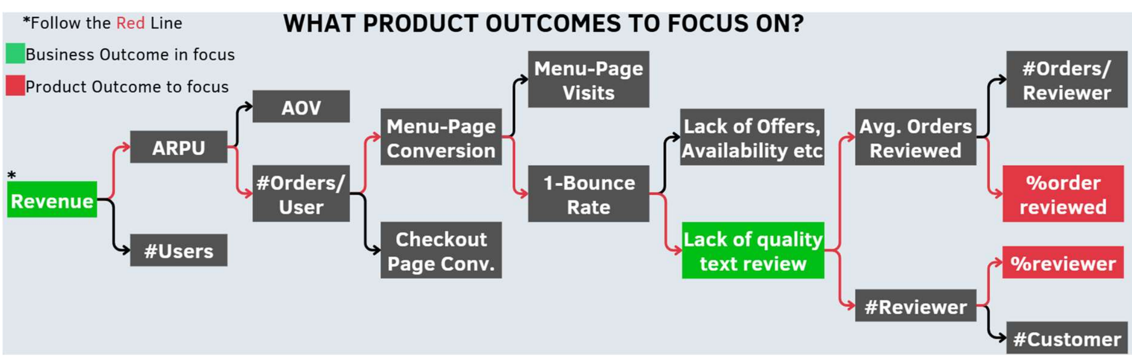
Increase revenue through quality reviews by increasing review frequency from loyal reviewers & converting casual reviewers into loyal ones by resolving the biggest bottleneck.

To influence # quality (relevance, recency, depth) text reviews the goal is to increase the:

- % users who review (>12 orders in 3 months, rated at least once in last 3 months)
- % orders reviewed with the text review

Business - Product Outcome Mapping

Items mentioned in green are the Business Outcomes, and the ones mentioned in red are product outcomes.



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Success Metrics

Nature of Metrics	Priority	Importance
Functional Metrics		
1. % change in # monthly reviews	**Focus Metrics**	Helps determine if the solution turns casual reviewers into loyal ones or discourages further
2. % change in monthly active text reviewers	L1	helps determine if the solution turns casual reviewers into loyal ones or discourages further
3. % change in orders with text reviews	L1	helps assess if the solution streamlines reviews to increase order volume
4. % change in menu- checkout conversion	L1	helps measure the correlation between quality text review and menu checkout conversion
5. CTR on recent review/order	L1	helps assess if recent review aids in ordering
6. Avg time to write a review/user	L2	helps validate the extent to which the solution is effective in reducing complexities
7. Avg # of clicks on mic button/rating	L2	helps validate if the solution has Usability & issue
8. Review Abandonment Rate	**Failure Metric**	helps measure if the user drop-off after using the feature or not
9. Order Abandonment Rate	**Failure Metric**	helps measure if user drop-offs without ordering, post-checking recent review
Non-Functional Metrics		
1. Latency	L3	A higher latency → poor experience
2. API Response Time	L3	helps monitor the API call performance
3. Crash rate	L3	helps monitor performance in different OS & devices
4. Memory & CPU utilisation	L3	help monitor the impact on devices & system

Only these metrics are considered **part of the goal as they can be measured** & **controlled directly by the review & ratings team**.

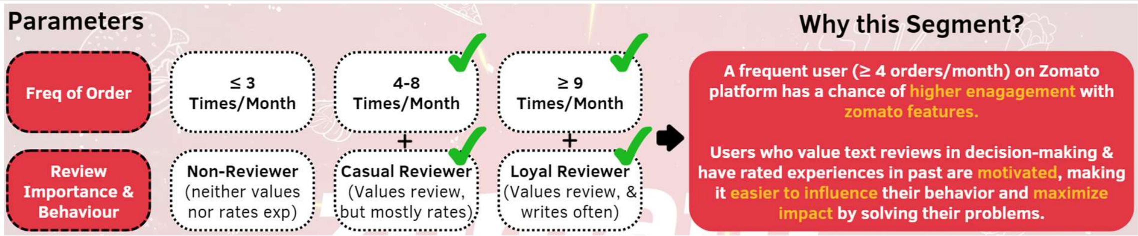
Non-Goals

- All other business verticals of Zomato like Going-out, Hyperpure, & Blinkit
- Avg order value, Increasing Positive/Negative reviews, Increasing photo reviews, Increasing Text Review below 4 characters etc.

Are excluded from the scope, as they have a low impact on the goal due to **poor correlation & causation**, and they are **beyond the team's control.**

User Segmentation

From Product outcome mapping, it is evident that users who order frequently & value review in decision-making are highly active & motivated. Hence, easier to influence.



Size & Impact Analysis

Target Segment Identification

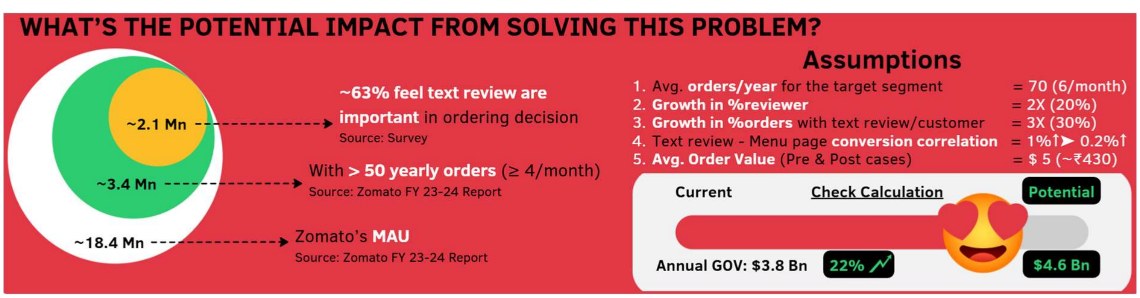
- Frequent orders (>=12 orders in last 3 months)
- Provided ratings/reviews in the past (recent 3 months)

Assumptions

Due to the lack of actual data, the following assumptions are taken after careful thought:

- **% current customers who review** = **10%** (~0.21 Mn)
- Potential **lift in reviewer** = **2X** (20%)
- Current **%orders with text review** for the target segment = **10%**
- Potential **lift in text review** after 1 year = **3X** (30%)
- **%Growth in total review** = **5X** or 500%
- **Avg. orders/month** for the target segment = **6 orders**
- **1%** increase in **text review** → **0.15%** increase in **Menu-Checkout page conversion**
- **Avg order value is $5** (~INR 430) which is uncorrelated with the solution

Impact = #Users * Annual Order * AOV * %Inc in Conversion
= 2.14 Mn*70*5*(1.0015^500-1) = 2.14*70*5*1.116 = **$0.836 Mn** extra annual GOV



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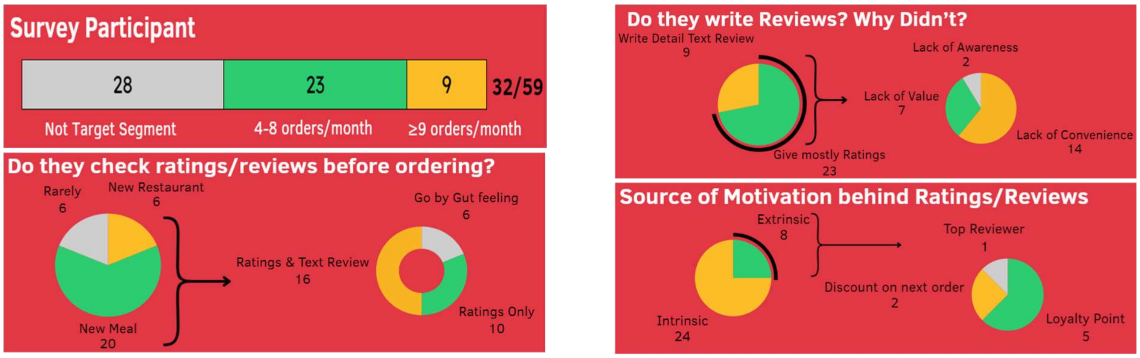
Problem Validation

The initial **hypothesis** behind a low-text review was assumed as:

1. **Lack of Awareness:** Users don't know where to read or write a text review
2. **Lack of Value:** Users don't feel their reviews matter or worth the effort
3. **Lack of Recall:** They don't remember their experience. Hence, don't write it
4. **Lack of Convenience:** Users find review experience energy & time intensive

To validate these hypotheses, people in the age group of 18-35 years are circulated with this survey form, followed by 3 in-person interviews. Stats basis survey response sheet:



Customer Research Outcome:

1. 50% of users check text reviews before ordering. While 38% check only ratings as they're unaware of the reviews section. **Validating Lack of Awareness**.

2. 28% of users are loyal reviewers, while 72% casually rate their experience. **Validating Lack of Convenience** (61%) & **Lack of Value** (30%).

3. **The majority** (75%) of users were **intrinsically motivated** to share their experience while only 25% gave feedback based on external stimuli, with only 25% >= 9 orders/month.

4. The **Lack of recall hypothesis was not confirmed**.

Competitor Research

Competitors in eCommerce, Ticketing, Travel & Food delivery verticals were analysed, and it was observed that very few competitors have explored Audio or AI-based review generation.

During Review Experience	Flipkart	bookmyshow	Tripadvisor	Swiggy	Zomato
Rating explantion (emoji/text)	🟢	⚪	🟢	🟢	⚪
Voice Based/AI enabled Review	⚪	⚪	⚪	⚪	⚪
Top-reviewer recommendation	🟢	⚪	⚪	⚪	⚪
Keyword based review	⚪	🟢	⚪	⚪	⚪
Conversational tone for seeking information?	⚪	⚪	🟢	🟢	⚪
Post Review Experience					
Nudge to write detail review second time?	⚪	⚪	🟢	⚪	⚪
Catchy Thank you message	🟢	⚪	🟢	🟢	⚪
Rewards for detailed text/image review	⚪	⚪	⚪	⚪	⚪

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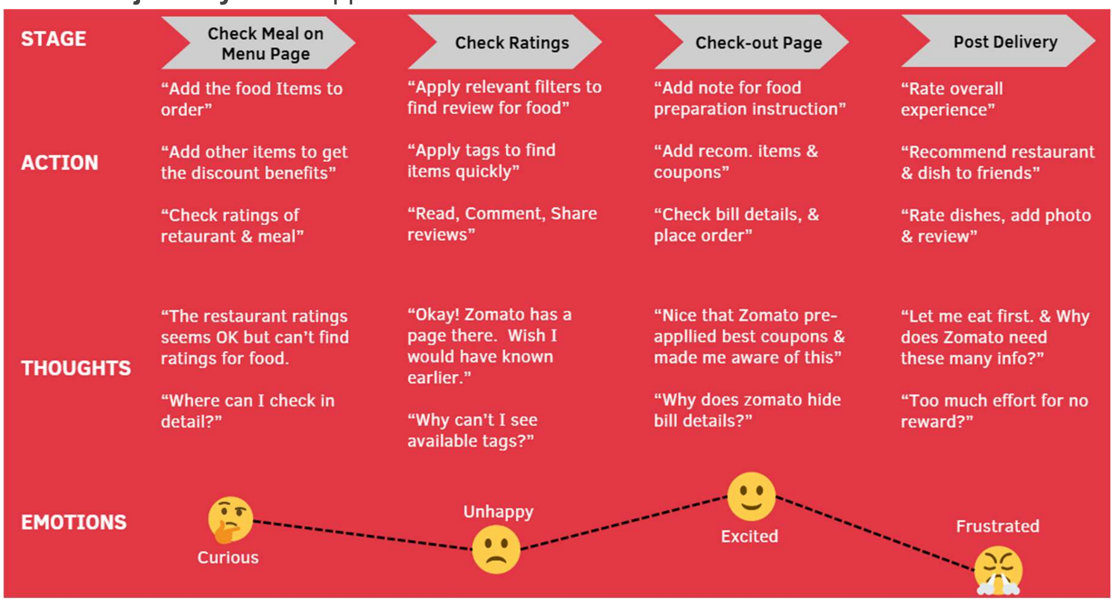
Top 5 takeaways from customer and competitor research:

1. Most **users are intrinsically motivated** to give feedback **but refrain from reviewing** due to a **lack of convenience** or **perceived value**.
2. Users want to **spend < 30 seconds** on the review page.
3. A section of **users seek to feel valued** for their efforts.
4. Some users are **unaware of the menu-page review feature** & want discoverability.
5. Few competitors have experimented with **Audio** or **AI-based review** generation, providing a **differentiation opportunity**.

Understanding the target audience

Basis the survey & user interviews the **user persona** for the target audience looks like this:

The **user's journey** in the app looks like:



Unmet Needs/Pain-Points

Pain-points/Needs	Alignment to goal	Severity of Problem	Ranking
Too much time taking (<30 sec)	**High** 61% feel this way	**High** Occurs every time one reviews	**High**
Lack of perceived value for their review	**Medium** 30% feel this way	**High** Occurs when there are already many ratings	High-Med
No incentive for the user	**Medium** 25% feel this way	**Medium** Occurs when users seek external reward	Medium
Lacks knowledge of the Review feature on the Menu Page	**Medium** 38% feel this way	**Low** Don't address the problem directly	Med-Low

Given **that too much time** & **Lack of perceived value** are the **biggest bottleneck**, let's address it in the **MVP**.

Descoped

1. **Image-based reviews** are not part of the scope as **a picture may explain 1000 words**, but **without text, they will be inconclusive**.
2. Using a **GPT-based review system is intriguing** but comes with **significant associated risks** and would be effort-intensive to implement, hence descoped.
3. Collecting **reviews in push notification** is descoped due to **technical feasibility risk** & risk of losing feedback on food reviews/photo reviews/ sharing with friends.

Offering **monetary rewards** for reviews is described, as providing monetary rewards that may **undermine trust** in the review process.

Solution

A couple of product Ideas were ideated ([Source Mind Map URL]) to address the issue of time-intensive, boring & lack of perceived value experience. Here are the top 3 solutions:

Lean Review with Speech-text	Keyword-Based AI Review	AI Review Assistant
 **How does it work?** - Users give the overall feedback for the order, basis which generic #tags (for portion, taste & packing) are shown for each food item. Users are asked for a detailed review which can be captured using voice inputs (using offline/online Automatic Speech Recognition tools like Google ASR, and Apple Dictation). Users are made aware of the value of the review. These reviews will undergo control using NLU to remove reviews which contain abusive language, etc. **Benefits? -** Speeds up the review process (≤30 seconds) and reduces effort & anxiety. **Any Risks?** - Usability issues (ambient noise, pronunciation) may cause errors.	 **How does it work?** - Based on overall feedback, keywords for categories - Taste, Quantity, Packaging, & Delivery (optional) are auto-generated. These categories are relevant to the audience as verified from user research. No need to collect further information on delivery if done in time. A GPT model uses these keywords to create human-like reviews. Users can edit and post the review. Eg: A noodle with a 3 out of 5 rating, and reached in time will have: Taste - #BlandBites, #BurstOfFlavour Quantity - #JustRightServinf, #LessForPrice Packaging - #NeatlyPacked, #MessyPacked **Benefits? -** Creates quality reviews with minimal input. **Any Risks?** - Keywords may feel generic, affecting review credibility.	 **How does it work?** - Users provide overall feedback & a default text review will be populated based on their rating and the restaurant's previous reviews. Users can make final edits and save the response. For multiple orders, there can be an up/down vote icon to understand which item the customer liked or disliked. **Benefits? -** Simplifies review process. **Any Risks?** - Repetitive formats may reduce trust.

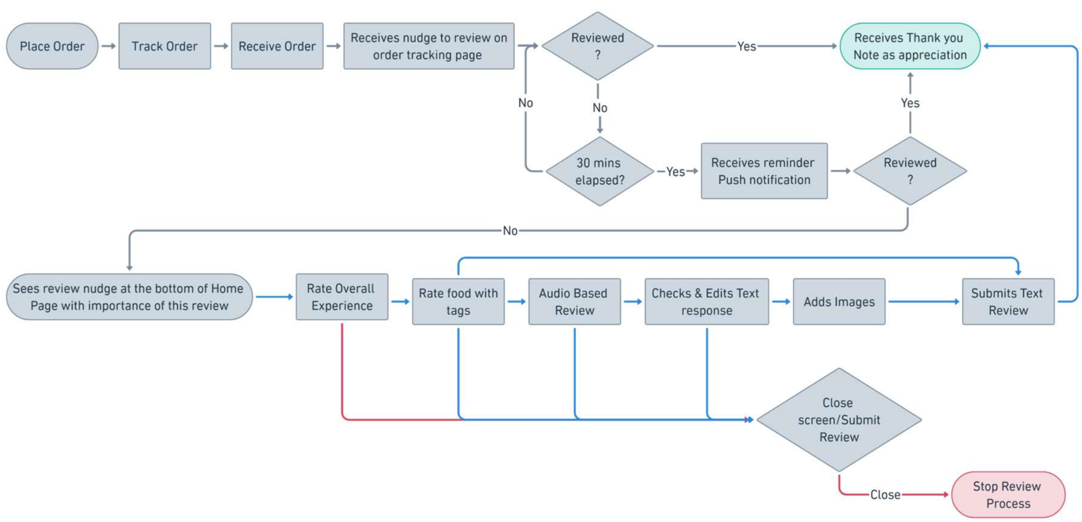
Solution Prioritization

Solution	Reach (R)	Impact (I)	Confidence(C)	Effort (E)	Score= R*I*C/E
1. **Voice-Text Review**	5	5	4	4	25
2. **Keyword AI Review**	5	4	3	5	12
3. **AI Review Assistant**	4	3	3	4	9

The **audio-based review** seems to be the **most promising idea** and **new to the industry**.

User Flow

Here Blue Line shows the desired flow & Red Line shows the undesired flow.



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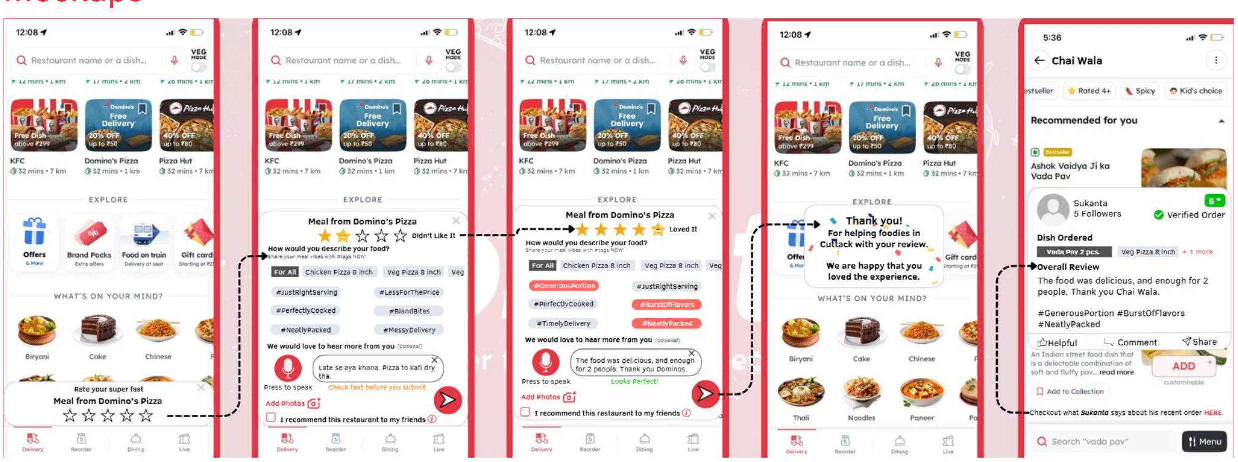
Mockups



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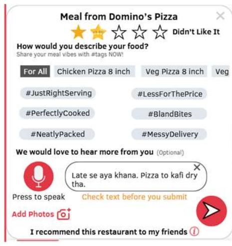
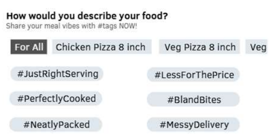
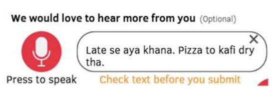
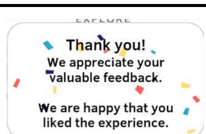
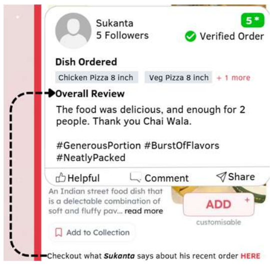
User Stories

Below is the breakdown of key features and the tasks/subtask & acceptance criteria:

Feature	User Story	Tasks (with Acceptance Criteria)
 **Embedded Review Page**	"As a user, I should be able to access the review page without leaving the home page so that I have a smoother UX"	1. Users should have two layout options: ● Less than half (A-type) ● 70% of the screen (B-type) 2. Users should feel like the section appears from the bottom.
 **Rating Explanation**	"As a user, I should be able to see the explanation of my rating so that I have a better understanding & hence experience"	1. Users should see the text beside the overall rating in bold letters. E.g: "Loved It" 2. Users should see the final rating star in an emoji form to convey the emotion further.
 **Tag-Based Rating**	"As a user, I should be able to rate my food using hashtags so that I spend less energy in decision making"	1. Users should be able to see 2 related #tags each for Portion Size, Food Taste, and Packaging/Delivery; based the rating chosen. 2. Users if want can share separate #tags for individual items or "For All" items one go. 3. Users should be able to modify tags until submission.
 **Voice-to-Text Interaction**	"As a user, I should be able to interact with the speech-text mic button so that I can record my voice review and see the outcome"	1. Users should be able to press once or hold the "Mic Button" for up to 120 seconds. 2. Users should be able to see the text output appearing on the verify screen. 3. Users should be able to stop conversion with 5 sec of silence (no relevant audio response). 4. Users should be able to reject, edit, and retry with guidance for optimal voice input. 5. Users should be allowed 5 attempts to record their voice before manual input is required.
 **Submit Button**	"As a user, I should be able to see a "Send" icon so that I can submit my feedback"	1. Users should be able to click to submit feedback. 2. Users should be able to submit feedback even without adding any additional info.
 **ThankYou Notification**	"As a user, I should feel valued for providing my feedback so that I feel intrinsically motivated to repeat the action"	1. Users receive a "Thank You" notification with personalised text reflecting their feedback (e.g. "We are *happy*/*sad* that you *loved*/*liked*/*didn't like* the experience")

 **Recent Review**	"As a user, I should be able to check the latest reviews by users so that I can make ordering decisions faster"	1. Users should be able to quickly view recent reviews under each food item, with reviewer details and an actionable CTA. 2. Clicking the CTA reveals the full review with relevant hashtags. 3. Users can like, comment, or share without leaving the screen.

Risk & Mitigation

The following risks were anticipated prior-launch & the mitigation for them has been updated:

Risk	Mitigation
Value Risk: Users may find the compact UI cumbersome. OR The recent review might be significantly different	**A/B Testing:** A/B test UI & feature ability to improve review **Most Relevant Review:** The user sees the most popular & recent rating that mimics the current rating of food items.
Usability Risk: Users might find the feature cumbersome if faced with frequent error	**Prompt User:** The user gets feedback as actionable when the feature isn't able to recognize the audio properly
Feasibility Risk: Running an offline speech model requires decent device processing power, limiting the reach	**Online ASR as backup:** Switch to online Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR) in case the device has low-spec or the CPU & Memory uses reaches a cap
Scalability Issues: There might be a quality control (QC) nightmare, as the reviews count increases, and offline.	**NLU Basic QC:** Natural Language Understanding (NLU) solutions can help infer the context at scale and restrict prohibited content post-sharing.
API Down There might be an issue relating to API response, which might be out of control	**Default Mode:** Disable Voice-Text mic button, if offline ASR can't be used.

Data & Logic Changes

Algorithm/Logic changes:

- **New Rating Calculation**: Individual food items will now have ratings calculated as **0.6×Overall Rating+0.4×Existing Rating**, giving more weight to recency.
- **Delivery Partner Rating:** Completely based on the meal experience & current rating.

Schema Changes & New Data Types

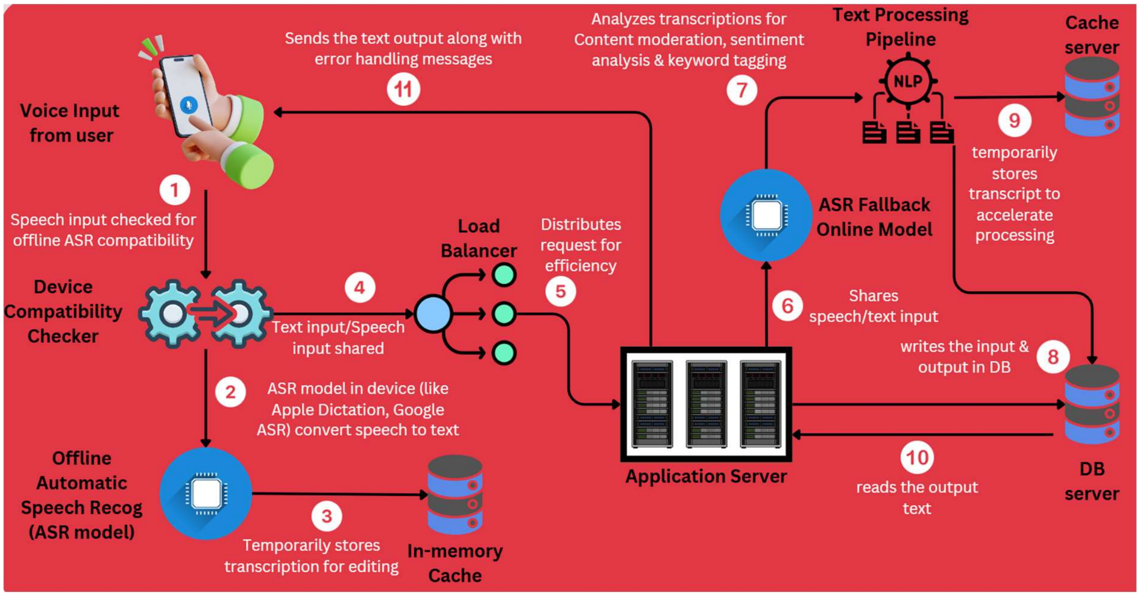
Data Introduced	Data type	Description
hashtags	VARCHAR (100)	Selected hashtags, comma-separated
review_check_status	BOOLEAN	Indicates if the recent review was clicked before the order
mic_click_count	INTEGER (1)	Counts mic button interactions/review
rating_explanation	VARCHAR (15)	Explain text for Rating e.g., 1/5 - "Hated It"

Data Instrumentation

Below are the details of events/variables that will help track Key Functional Metrics:

Key Metrics	Event	Variables
% change in # monthly reviews	review_submitted	**user_id, restaurant_id, review_id, review_status, review_submitted_datetime**
% change in monthly active text reviewers	review_submitted	**user_id, restaurant_id, review_id, review_status, review_submitted_datetime**
% change in % orders with text reviews	order_delivered review_submitted	**order_id, restaurant_id, order_status, user_id, review_id, review_status, review_submitted_datetime**
% change in menu-checkout conversion	menu-page opened check-out page_opened	**user_id, session_id, restaurant_id, menupage_CTA_status, menupage_open_status**
CTR on recent review/order	order_delivered recent_review_clicked	**order_id, restaurant_id, order_status, user_id, order_datetime, order_value, review_check_status**
Review Abandonment Rate	review_initiated mic_clicked review_closed	**user_id, restaurant_id, review_id, review_status, review_initiated_datetime, mic_click_count**
Order Abandonment Rate	session_initiated recent_review_clicked session_closed	**user_id, session_id, restaurant_id, review_id, review_check_status, order_status**

System Design



Scenario Based Test (Edge Case)

Below edge cases are to be tested as per the condition & desired outcome, before release:

ID	Test Case Objective & Pre-conditions	Test Inputs	Acceptable Outcome
1	**Objective:** Optimise review UI	The user clicks between two hashtags.	Max one output captured
2	**Objective:** Check speech-text performance **Precondition:** User rates overall experience	The user uses the speech-text option but does not speak anything legible	Stop capturing input if an illegible voice for 5 seconds. Share the message to “speak louder” / “closer to the mic”
3	**Objective:** Check speech-text performance **Precondition:** User tried voice input feature > 5 times in one review session	The user clicks/pushes the mic button for the 6th time.	Prompt to manually write or just submit a review
4	**Objective:** Check notification flow **Precondition:** The user has not added any inputs except for the overall rating in the first notification section	The user clicks on the submit button.	Users should be asked to share at least one tag

Launch Readiness

Here is how the overall checklist of activities looks for the launch readiness.

S/N	Milestones	Status	Check Lists	Timeline
1	Design Sign Off	Completed	• Med. Fidelity Wireframe • Respond to open queries from the design team • High Fidelity Mockups	**Sept W4 - Sept W5**
2	PRD Sign-Off for MVP	Completed	• Problem Validation • Solution Ideation • Update User-stories • Respond to open queries from the dev & analytics team	**Sept W5 - Oct W1**
3	Development	Started	• Sign-off on Technical Sheet • Complete the first sprint plan • Create product backlog for the next 2 sprint cycles	**Oct W1 - Oct W4**
4	QA Testing	Yet to Start (On Track)	• Scenario Testing • Sound Testing • Smoke Testing	**Oct W2 - Nov W1**
5	Dogfooding (UAT/Beta-Test)	Yet to Start (On Track)	• Alpha Test Sign-off • Beta Test Sign-off • A/B test scenario sign-off	**Oct W3 - Nov W3**
6	KPI dashboard	Yet to Start (On Track)	• New metrics added to MIS • Data Pipeline integrity test	**Nov W1 - Nov W4**

Future Iterations

Goal for the next release: Automate QC to **reduce effort & risks** relating to **manual QC**, and **focus on increasing review engagement & value** for users.

User Story	High-Level Idea	Version
"As a user, I should be able to avoid abusing content in the review section so that I don't feel negative emotions"	Reviews go through an ML algorithm to remove such content using NLU (Natural Language Understanding).	Future Release (**P1**)
"As a user, I should be able to look through reviews effortlessly so that I quickly order my food"	Users will be able to filter reviews using word search. And can see the AI review summary with top keywords for taste, packaging, and portion.	Future Release (**P1**)
"As a user, I should be able to use my	The algorithm will be trained to	Future

local tongue to leave a text review so that I have a native experience”	improve its ability to comprehend popular local dialects.	Release (**P2**)
“As a user, I should be able to use my voice as a prompt to create GPT-based quality reviews so that I don’t feel conscious about grammar and tone etc”	Users' voice input shall be passed to GPT as a prompt to create a quick quality review. Thus reducing the speaking anxiety.	Future Release (**P2**)
“As a user, I should be able to see how my review makes me a Top voice on the platform so that I feel additionally motivated to review”	User reviews shall lead them to the top reviewer tag and users will be recommended to improve their tags.	Future Release (**P2**)
“As a user, I should be notified when my text review is posted on the restaurant Page & interacted with by restaurant/other members so that I feel the real impact of my review”	Live updates relating to review interaction shall be shown to users similar to LinkedIn.This has the potential to improve review engagement.	Future Release (**P2**)